



f3-82540078

Game Developer | Unity & Unreal Engine Specialist

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📄 Profiles

🐙 **GitHub**
[dkowalski-dev](https://github.com/dkowalski-dev)

🌐 **LinkedIn**
[davidkowalski](https://www.linkedin.com/in/davidkowalski)

👤 Skills

🔗 **Unity Engine**
Expert
C#, Editor Tools, Performance Profiling
☆☆☆☆☆

🔗 **Unreal Engine**
Advanced
C++, Blueprints, UE5 Features
☆☆☆☆☆

🔗 **Programming Languages**
Expert
C#, C++, Python, HLSL/GLSL
☆☆☆☆☆

🔗 **Game AI**
Advanced
Behavior Trees, FSM, Pathfinding, Navigation
☆☆☆☆☆

🔗 **Physics & Mathematics**
Advanced
3D Math, Collision Detection, Rigid Body Dynamics
☆☆☆☆☆

📄 Summary

Passionate game developer with 5+ years of professional experience creating engaging gameplay systems and polished player experiences across multiple platforms. Specialized in Unity and Unreal Engine with strong expertise in C#, C++, and game design principles. Proven ability to collaborate effectively with cross-functional teams including designers, artists, and QA to deliver high-quality games on time and within scope.

🎓 Education

University of Washington Bachelor of Science • 3.6 GPA
Computer Science Seattle, WA • 2014 - 2018
Concentration in Game Development. Relevant Coursework: Game Engine Architecture, Computer Graphics, Artificial Intelligence, Physics Simulation, 3D Mathematics, Software Engineering, Data Structures & Algorithms

📁 Experience

Cascade Studios Seattle, WA
Senior Game Developer March 2022 - Present

- Lead gameplay programmer on an unannounced AAA action-adventure title built in Unreal Engine 5 for PC and next-gen consoles
- Architected and implemented core combat system including hit detection, combo mechanics, and enemy AI behavior trees serving 15+ enemy types
- Developed custom editor tools in C++ that reduced level designer iteration time by 40% and improved workflow efficiency across the team
- Optimized rendering pipeline and gameplay systems to maintain 60 FPS performance target on all supported platforms, achieving 95% frame rate stability
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 Certifications

**Unity Certified Expert:
Programmer**

March 2022
Unity Technologies

Unreal Engine 5 C++ Developer

June 2023
Epic Games (Udemy)

 Languages

English
Native
★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Polish
Conversational
★ ★ ★ ★ ★

 Interests

 **Game Design**
Mechanics, Level Design, Player Psychology

 **AI & Procedural Generation**
PCG, Machine Learning, Emergent Gameplay

 **Indie Game Development**
Solo Dev, Game Jams, Community

 **Technical Art**
Shaders, VFX, Optimization

 References

Available upon request

 Experience

Pixel Forge Interactive

Bellevue, WA

Game Developer

June 2020 - February 2022

- Core developer on 'Starbound Odyssey,' a sci-fi roguelike that achieved 500K+ sales on Steam with 'Very Positive' user reviews
- Implemented procedural generation systems for level layouts, enemy encounters, and loot drops using Unity and C#
- Designed and programmed player progression systems including skill trees, equipment upgrades, and meta-progression mechanics
- Created robust save/load system supporting cloud saves and cross-platform play between PC and Nintendo Switch
- Integrated third-party SDKs for analytics (GameAnalytics), achievements (Steamworks), and multiplayer networking (Photon)
- Fixed critical bugs and balanced gameplay based on community feedback and telemetry data, releasing 12 post-launch content updates
- Worked closely with artists to implement VFX, animations, and shaders that enhanced visual polish while maintaining performance targets

Mobile Games Studio

Remote

Junior Game Developer

September 2018 - May 2020

- Contributed to development of three mobile puzzle games built in Unity, collectively downloaded 2M+ times on iOS and Android
- Implemented UI systems, touch controls, and gesture recognition optimized for mobile devices and various screen sizes
- Developed monetization features including rewarded video ads, in-app purchases, and daily reward systems that increased retention by 25%
- Optimized memory usage and load times for mobile platforms, reducing app size by 35% through asset compression and code optimization
- Collaborated with game designers to balance puzzle difficulty curves and progression pacing using A/B testing data

 Awards

Best Gameplay - Ludum Dare 48

April 2021

Ludum Dare

Awarded for puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' which ranked in the top 5% overall among 3,000+ submissions

Employee Excellence Award

December 2021

Pixel Forge Interactive

Recognized for exceptional contributions to 'Starbound Odyssey' development and dedication to code quality

<> Projects

- Echoes of the Void (Indie Game)

2023 - Present

Solo developer for a narrative-driven 2D platformer built in Unity. Features custom dialogue system, branching story paths, and atmospheric pixel art. Currently in development with demo released on itch.io garnering 5K+ downloads and positive community feedback. Planned Steam release Q2 2025.

[View on itch.io](#)
- Open Source: Unity Dialogue Framework

2021 - 2023

Created and maintain an open-source dialogue system for Unity with visual node-based editor, localization support, and voice acting integration. Project has 800+ GitHub stars and is actively used by indie developers worldwide. Includes comprehensive documentation and example projects.

[View on GitHub](#)
- Game Jam Participation

2019 - Present

Regular participant in Ludum Dare and Global Game Jam events. Created 12+ game prototypes exploring experimental mechanics and art styles. Won 'Best Gameplay' award at Ludum Dare 48 with puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' that ranked in top 5% overall.

📖 Publications

- Optimizing Unity Games for Mobile: A Practical Guide

September 2021

Game Developer Magazine

Technical article covering mobile optimization techniques including draw call batching, LOD systems, and memory management
- Building Modular Dialogue Systems

May 2022

Seattle Indie Game Developers Meetup

Presented talk on designing flexible dialogue systems for narrative games, attended by 60+ local developers

🤝 Volunteer

- Seattle Indies

2020 - Present

Seattle, WA

Active member of local indie game development community. Organize monthly game showcases and provide mentorship to aspiring game developers through code reviews and technical guidance.
- Code.org Game Development Workshops

2021 - Present

Seattle, WA

Volunteer instructor teaching basic game programming concepts to middle school students. Led 8+ workshops introducing Unity fundamentals and game design principles.

Hiring Manager
Sunrise Games Studio
Seattle, WA
hiring@sunrisegames.com

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm excited to apply for the Senior Gameplay Engineer role at Sunrise Games Studio. Over the past five years, I have shipped cross-platform titles in Unity and Unreal Engine, leading core gameplay and tooling efforts that improved iteration speed and player experience. At Cascade Studios, I architected combat systems and optimized performance to maintain 60 FPS on console while partnering closely with design and art.

I thrive in collaborative, cross-disciplinary teams and enjoy mentoring junior engineers. I'd welcome the chance to bring my gameplay systems expertise and tooling focus to your next title.

Sincerely,
David Kowalski